A-A-51410
16 April 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SUTURE, NONABSORBABLE, SURGICAL
Polypropylene, Monofilament, Single Armed

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a sterile polypropylene surgical suture suitable for general surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

Materials. The suture shall be made of monofilament polpropylene, dyed and uncoated. The needle shall be made of corrosion-resistant steel properly hardened, tempered and passivated.

Design and construction. The suture shall be dyed, uncoated monofilament polypropylene. The suture shall be size 0 and 30 inches (76cm) long. A half-circle needle, with a taper cut and nominal 1-1/2 inches straight length, shall be attached to one end of the suture. The size shall be in accordance with USP limits for diameter. The suture shall have a minimum knot-pull tensile strength of 2.3 Kgf at an S-2 inspection level and AQL of 1.5 of MIL-STD-105D. The needle shall be bored and swaged to the suture. One suture shall be in an envelope, the inner container. The inner container shall be contained in an outer container, the packet, designed for peel-back opening. The inner container shall be made of plastic, aluminum foil or aluminum foil-plastic laminate. The inner container and outer envelope shall be hermetically sealed. The outer envelope or packet shall be designed to facilitate ready opening and aseptic deposit of the inner container onto a sterile field. The free fall of the inner container shall not be impeded by sticking or any other cause. The inner container shall permit resterilization in cold sterilization solutions. The suture and inner containers shall be sterile in accordance with the sterility test shown below.

FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

AMSC N/A

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A. Sterility Test. The polypropylene suture shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates it from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium for the paper spore strip (carrier) shall be soybean-casein digest. The incubation media for the inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product shall be fluid thioglycollate or alternative thioglycollate at 30° to 35°C for one half of the specimens and soybean-casein digest at 20° to 25°C for the remaining half of the specimens. The minimum incubation time shall be ten days. Sampling shall be as follows:

Medium	Paper Spore Strip	Inoc. Prod. or Inoc.Simulated Prod.
Soybean-casein digest	S-3*	S-3*
Fluid thioglycollate or Alternative thioglycollate		S-3*

*Use a minimum of 20 specimens. Acceptance number is zero.

A.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism
Steam	B. stearothermophilus
Dry heat	B. stearothermophilus B. subtilis
Ethylene oxide	B. subtilis
Gamma radiation	B. pumilus

The number of viable spores shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

A.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used, shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586A. Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in A. Sterility test and A.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in A.1.
NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP and paragraphs A and A.1.

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A.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Request for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

A.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP. The inspection level shall be as stated in paragraph A.3 above.

Workmanship. The suture shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing thirty-six individually packaged sutures as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one suture.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-153-4981	SUTURE, NONABSORABABLE, SURGICAL Polypropylene, Monofilament, Size 0, 30 Inches, Single Armed, 36s

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Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS

Project No. 6515-3569

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